



NO. 14 OF 16

Taylor Moss

THE STAGE MAGICIAN

“You can make a coin vanish. Can you make suspicion vanish too?”

FOR TAYLOR MOSS'S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A tailcoat, a top hat, a red silk handkerchief and a deck of cards.

MASK: Harlequin

DRESS STYLE

A sequined jacket over a black dress, a top hat and a deck of cards.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You perform close-up magic: cards, coins and the occasional vanishing coupe. Tonight Gus hired you to do tricks at the tables.

YOUR SECRET

Your famous “Midnight Blackout” stage act works by unscrewing a fuse. Last year at the Gilded Owl the act went wrong and Morgan Bellamy banned you. Gus knew, and joked tonight that “Taylor could put the lights out any time”.

You are innocent

From 11:45 until after the lights came back you were dealing card tricks at table 4, beside the tower, for Sidney Hart and a crowd of guests.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING TAYLOR

Your manner: Playful and mysterious. Produce a card from behind someone’s ear and answer questions with riddles.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Do a little trick for someone. Share: you heard no click from the bandstand when the lights went out, so it wasn't the stage switch.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Explain, as an expert: an unscrewed fuse (Evidence 1) needs no skill at all, just five seconds and an empty corridor. Anyone could do it.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit your Midnight Blackout act if asked. Point out that you were dealing cards at table 4 in front of a crowd, Sidney Hart included.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club